



him. They were trying to give him so much money, to afford a big house for his family.

But he turned it down because he was a Birmingham fan. He wanted to play for Birmingham before anything else."

In 2019, Stewart returned to Rangers, the club that had released him as a boy. He helped the team win its first league title in 10 years, securing his first major silverware.

"I think whenever you get knocked down, don't give up," Stewart said.

The 34-year-old scored thrice and provided seven assists for the club. One of his touchstones there was Liverpool legend and then-Rangers manager, Steven Gerrard.

"Steven was massive, coming in as a manager. He made me see a

different side of football and made me realise and understand it from a coach's perspective — the details he gave when he was on the training field were second to none," he said.

"He was a winner himself and had that desire. He would join (us at the) training ground, and you could see how good he was."

#### Eyeing a hat-trick

Stewart is a force in league matches for ISL sides. In 76 games, he has only lost four.

"It's good for (my) confidence and (can be) massive for the team if we can go on a winning run, so we gain confidence and believe in each other," Stewart said.

However, his eyes are set on the ultimate measure of success in football — silverware. "I have won

**Chasing glory:** Greg Stewart's eyes are set on the ultimate measure of success in football — silverware. The 34-year-old aims to win his third ISL Shield title, this time with Mohun Bagan. GETTY IMAGES

two (ISL Shield) titles, with Jamshedpur FC and Mumbai City. Hopefully, I can make it three with Mohun Bagan," he said.

Once rejected by Hearts, Stewart has learned to win many hearts over the years and continues to do so in India. "I feel I have done well in my career. I've managed to support my family, which is always good. I still feel I've got plenty of years left in me. I still feel young. So, I'm going to play as long as possible until my legs give up," he said.